

Repair Cafés: Make Do And Mend [B2]

In questa società usa e getta, la vera rivoluzione sta nel riparare e rammendare. Abitudini che fanno bene all'ambiente... e al portafoglio!

It's a simple concept: [fix up](#) an item instead of [tossing](#) it in the [rubbish](#). But in today's [throwaway](#) society, the '[make do and mend](#)' philosophy of previous generations has been lost. Across the EU, thirty-five million tonnes of repairable [goods](#) are discarded annually, along with twenty-two million damaged [pieces of furniture](#) and 11,000 bicycles. Thankfully, that trend is changing, helped by a global network of repair cafés that make learning repair skills fun and easy.

VOLUNTEERS

Repair cafés started in 2007 when Martine Postma, a Dutch environmentalist, produced a guide for her local community with tips on how to repair clothes, furniture, [electrical appliances](#), bicycles, [crockery](#), toys and other [household items](#). A Repair Café in Amsterdam soon followed, where items could be brought in to be mended for free. [Tools](#) and materials were provided and expert volunteers were available to provide repair skills. There are now more than 2,500 repair cafés worldwide, including 250 in the UK. Current Affairs

How a Colombian Influencer Made Recycling Cool Sara Samaniego si presenta come la prima influencer del riciclo dell'America Latina, attirando un'appassionata base di fan nella capitale colombiana, Bogotá, e istruendo i suoi seguaci su come pulire e differenziare i rifiuti attraverso il suo personaggio, Marce la Recicladora. Genevieve Glatsky

WRITTEN INTO LAW

Repair cafés are [funded](#) by donations, [grants](#) and [partnerships](#). The cafés are intended to complement rather than compete with professional repair services. Consumers are helped by new Right to Repair legislation,

introduced by the European Commission and rewritten into UK law when it left the EU. The initiative places obligations on manufacturers to make it easier to find [spare parts](#) and instructions for repairing items. The cost of living crisis has also had an impact, with families desperate to save money. In 2024, 55 per cent of UK adults repaired an item rather than replacing it. Fashion is one of the most polluting industries on the planet. In previous centuries, repairing items of clothing was a basic life skill. But fast fashion and cheap clothing have reduced the [lifespan](#) of everybody's [wardrobes](#). So what can be done? Take your favourite clothing to a repair café or professional repair service. Learn how to [darn](#), [patch](#), and [stitch](#), [knit](#) or [sew](#). Extending the life of a [garment](#) by one year reduces its environmental footprint by 25 per cent. If we're serious about reducing environmental damage, we need to make clothes, and many other [household items](#), last much longer.

HOW DO YOU SAY...?

Arrangiarsi, cavarsela. To make do. www.repaircafe.org/en

Glossary

- **crockery** = stoviglie
- **grants** = sovvenzioni
- **wardrobes** = armadi
- **throwaway** = usa e getta
- **spare parts** = pezzi di ricambio
- **darn** = rammendare
- **stitch** = ricamare
- **sew** = cucire
- **garment** = capo d'abbigliamento
- **partnerships** = collaborazioni
- **goods** = beni
- **Tools** = attrezzi
- **patch** = rattoppare
- **fix up** = aggiustare
- **rubbish** = spazzatura
- **household items** = articoli per la casa
- **funded** = finanziare
- **lifespan** = ciclo di vita, durata di vita
- **knit** = lavorare a maglia
- **tossing** = buttare
- **make do and mend** = arrangiarsi, riparare e riutilizzare
- **pieces of furniture** = mobili
- **electrical appliances** = elettrodomestici